

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ 8 6

♣ J 7 5 3 2



♠ 9 8 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 10 7 4 2

♣ A K 9 6

♠ Q J 5

♥ A J 10 9 6 3

♦ A K 5

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

It's a good thing you stopped at game - partner's hand is about as bad as it could be.

The PLAN turns out simple. You can't avoid either of the three black losers so you must eliminate the ♦ loser. You can ruff it in dummy. Just to be safe you pull one more round of trumps, then play ♦A, ♦K and ♦5, ruffing in dummy. You will eventually get to your hand (with a ♠ or a ♣ ruff) and pull the last trump.

This PLAN was not difficult.

Only a real beginner would have pulled all the trumps and not been able to ruff that ♦.

You have a nice hand, but 20 points is not strong enough to open 2♣.

So you open 1♥. Partner raises to 2♥.

Partner's raise to 2♥ shows 6-10 points. You figure that should be enough for game but even if he has the full 10 you are not in slam range. So you bid the game.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠A, then switches to ♥2.

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Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 10 8 6

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A 5

♠ 7 4

♥ K 5 3

♦ A K 9 6 2

♣ K Q 3



♠ K 6 5 3

♥ Q 9 7 4

♦ 10 8

♣ 9 7 4

♠ A 9

♥ A J 2

♦ Q J 3

♣ J 10 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♦

Pass

1♣

Pass

3NT

Pass

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q. East puts on the ♠K.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 5 : ♣ 0 : Total = 8

Let's say you hold up on the first ♠, hoping they switch suits. HA! They aren't about to switch suits and they drive out your ♠A at trick 2. That actually clears the situation up and makes this plan pretty simple to make.

You have taken 1 ♠, and you will surely make 5 ♦s. Despite the solidity of those ♣s you dare not try to win a ♣ trick, because the defenders will pounce on that first ♣ and then win a bunch of ♠ tricks.

So that makes it clear that you need 3 ♥ tricks, and there's only one way to get them. After taking your five ♦ tricks, play a ♥ to the ♥K, then a ♥ back, finessing the ♥J. Half of the time you will make this contract, the other half of the time they will bury you with ♠s.

You might think if you could just sneak one ♣ through you wouldn't have to depend on the ♥ finesse. But put yourself in West's chair. Do you really think he will let you win a ♣ when he sees he can defeat you by taking his ♣A and leading ♠ winners?

With 16 points as Responder you are not quite strong enough for a jump-shift to 2♦. That requires at least 17 points. A jump to 3NT fits the point range (16-18) but promises a stopper in all unbid suits. So instead you bid 1♦, knowing partner is forced to keep the bidding alive. He now replies 1NT. What is your next bid?

Until now you were thinking the hand might end up in a slam. Now, with partner's minimum rebid, you happily say 3NT which partner passes.

North would play 3NT.

Click

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q. East puts on the ♠K.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 8

♥ -

♦ 9 7 6 4

♣ Q 10 6 5 2

♠ 9 5 2

♥ K Q 9 2

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 7



♠ A 7 4

♥ J 8 6 3

♦ 10 5

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ 10 6 3

♥ A 10 7 5 4

♦ A J 2

♣ A K

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

You have 12 points which isn't quite enough to force to game.

It is just right for a limit raise though, so you bid 3♥.

Partner does bid the game.

North would play 4♥.

Click

South plays 4♥. The defense takes the first three ♠ tricks, then switches to a ♣.

South plays 4♥. The defense takes the first three ♠ tricks, then switches to a ♣.

Losers: ♠ 3 : ♥ ?? : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3+??

With no more outside losers your task is very very simple:**DO NOT LOSE A TRUMP TRICK.**

There is no problem if trumps split 2-2 or 3-1, so you can put your mind to 4-0 splits only. If West holds ♥ J 8 6 3 then it won't matter whether your first trump play is ♥ A or ♥ K, you will still be able to finesse the ♥ J. But if East holds ♥ J 8 6 3 it is vital that you first play either the ♥ K or ♥ Q. If you start with the ♥ A you will have lost your finesse position. The general rule is to first play a high trump from the hand that has two. That preserves a finesse through either defender's ♥ J x x x.

Visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ A. West would show out and you would learn that East held ♥ J 8 6 3 but you couldn't do anything about it.

Next visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ K. West would show out and you would play the ♥ Q, then a small ♥ finessing your ♥ 10.

Finally visualize the situation if your first play was the ♥ K and it was East who showed out. You would play a small ♥ to your ♥ A, then lead a ♥ toward dummy finessing with the ♥ 9.

Using the correct Plan guarantees the contract however ♥s split.